

HR Policy Manual

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Purpose

This HR Policy Manual establishes the company-wide requirements covering hiring, probation, performance reviews, promotion, disciplinary action, and separation. It provides a controlled reference for employees, supervisors, managers, and HR when handling employment-related matters.

The manual should be used together with applicable role documents, department procedures, and other controlled company policies. Where an HR matter requires a formal record, the responsible HR process should be followed rather than relying only on informal verbal communication.

The manual is effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. It is reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Probation and Confirmation

New hires serve a three-month probation. Confirmation is subject to a documented probation-review meeting between the employee, the direct supervisor, and HR. The meeting provides a formal point at which the employee's progress can be discussed and recorded.

Probation may be extended by two months once. A second extension requires Branch Manager approval. The extension arrangement should therefore be treated as a controlled employment decision rather than an informal continuation of probation.

Probation review practice

During the probation period, the direct supervisor should observe the employee's progress against the expectations of the assigned role. Relevant observations may include completion of assigned work, ability to follow applicable procedures, participation in required learning, and response to normal supervisory feedback.

The probation-review meeting should involve the employee, direct supervisor, and HR as required by the policy. The outcome should be documented so that the company has a clear record of the confirmation decision or any approved extension.

HR Policy Manual — Probation and Performance

1. Probation and Confirmation

Confirmation process

Confirmation is not treated as an automatic event at the end of the initial three-month period. The policy requires a documented probation-review meeting involving the employee, direct supervisor, and HR. The documentation should make the resulting employment status clear.

Where an extension is considered, the first extension can be for two months. A second extension is subject to Branch Manager approval. HR should retain the relevant record so that the employment history reflects the approved probation status.

Employees should use the probation period to raise questions about role expectations and seek clarification from their direct supervisor. Supervisors should communicate relevant expectations rather than leaving an employee to infer them.

2. Performance Review

All confirmed employees receive a bi-annual performance review in June and December. The ratings are Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations, Partially Meets, and Below Expectations.

Performance ratings feed into the annual increment cycle in July and the bonus in December. The review therefore provides a formal record that connects employee performance assessment with the company's stated annual compensation processes.

Review preparation

Employees should be prepared to discuss their work during each review period, including completed objectives, ongoing responsibilities, challenges, and areas where additional support may be required. Supervisors should base the discussion on work-related observations and the expectations associated with the employee's role.

A review should provide an opportunity to identify areas that require attention before the next review cycle. Where improvement is needed, the employee and supervisor can clarify the expected work standard and the actions required to move toward it.

Rating terminology

Exceeds Expectations: the employee's documented performance is assessed using the highest rating category in the policy.

Meets Expectations: the employee's performance is assessed as meeting the applicable expectations for the role.

Partially Meets: the review identifies areas where performance does not consistently meet the expected level.

Below Expectations: the review records performance below the expected level and should provide a clear basis for the employee and supervisor to understand the areas requiring attention.

HR Policy Manual — Conduct and Conflicts

3. Code of Conduct

Employees must not accept gifts or cash from customers or vendors. Any gift over PKR 1,000 must be declared to HR within three days. The rule applies to gifts received in connection with an employee's workplace role.

Conflicts of interest, especially personal side businesses in auto parts or auto repair, must be declared in writing at joining and whenever there is a change. Written declaration allows HR to maintain a clear record of the matter and determine the appropriate handling.

Gift handling

Employees should not treat a customer or vendor gift as a private matter when the gift is connected to their work. Where a gift exceeds the stated PKR 1,000 threshold, the employee must make the required declaration to HR within three days.

The declaration requirement creates a formal record and should be completed through the recognised HR process. Employees should provide the relevant information needed for HR to understand the circumstances of the gift.

Conflict-of-interest declarations

A conflict-of-interest declaration is required at joining and again when a relevant change occurs. The policy specifically highlights personal side businesses involving auto parts or auto repair because such activities can overlap with the company's business environment.

Employees should not wait for a conflict to become a workplace dispute before declaring it. A change in outside business activity that creates a relevant conflict should be declared in writing when the change occurs.

4. Disciplinary Action

The disciplinary ladder is: verbal counsel, written warning, final written warning, suspension without pay, and termination.

The normal ladder provides a sequence for disciplinary action. Employees should understand that the existence of a sequence does not remove the company's separate treatment of gross misconduct.

Gross misconduct

Gross misconduct includes theft, fraud, harassment, and a safety violation causing injury. These cases skip the normal disciplinary ladder and move straight to termination after investigation.

The policy expressly requires an investigation before termination in a gross-misconduct case. The investigation provides the formal basis for the disciplinary decision and should be handled through the responsible company process.

HR Policy Manual — Discipline and Separation

4. Disciplinary Action

Applying the disciplinary ladder

The disciplinary ladder begins with verbal counsel and progresses through written warning, final written warning, suspension without pay, and termination. HR and management should maintain the relevant records associated with formal disciplinary actions so that the employee's employment file reflects the action taken.

Employees receiving disciplinary action should be able to understand the workplace issue being addressed and the applicable company expectation. The responsible supervisor and HR should use the appropriate documented process for the matter.

Gross misconduct is handled differently. Theft, fraud, harassment, and a safety violation causing injury are identified by this policy as cases that skip the normal ladder and move straight to termination after investigation.

Records and confidentiality

Disciplinary information should be handled as an employment record and shared only with people who have a legitimate business need to access it. HR should retain the applicable documentation according to the company's record-management practices.

5. Separation

Confirmed employees who resign must provide one calendar month's notice. Before the last working day, the employee must complete the exit interview, full-and-final settlement process, and asset return.

An experience certificate is issued within seven working days of clearance. Clearance therefore forms an important part of the separation process because the experience certificate timing is linked to completion of the required clearance.

Resignation and notice

A resignation should be handled through the company's formal HR process so that the notice period and planned last working day are clear. For confirmed employees, the policy specifies one calendar month of notice.

During the notice period, employees should continue to perform their assigned responsibilities and cooperate with the normal transition process. Managers may use the period to identify outstanding work and required handover information.

Exit interview

The exit interview is mandatory before the last working day. It provides HR with a formal opportunity to complete the separation process and capture relevant employee feedback.

The employee should cooperate with the exit process and provide the information requested through the official HR procedure. The exit interview is one component of separation and does not replace asset return or full-and-final settlement.

HR Policy Manual — Clearance and Policy Ownership

5. Separation

Full-and-final settlement

Full-and-final settlement is mandatory before the last working day. The employee should complete the required HR and finance steps so that outstanding employment-related matters can be reviewed and cleared.

The policy does not specify individual settlement components or calculation formulas in this document. Questions about specific settlement items should therefore be directed to the HR department rather than assuming additional rules from this manual.

Asset return

Asset return is mandatory before the last working day. Employees should return company property assigned to them through the applicable clearance process. The relevant record should identify that the required return has been completed.

Asset clearance should be treated separately from the employee's normal work handover. Completing one does not remove the requirement to complete the other.

Experience certificate

The experience certificate is issued within seven working days of clearance. Employees should therefore complete the required clearance activities so that HR can process the certificate within the stated period.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the Human Resources department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner.

Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual. HR is responsible for maintaining the controlled policy and reviewing it annually.

Employee and Manager Reference

Probation: New hires serve three months. Confirmation requires a documented review meeting involving the employee, direct supervisor, and HR. One two-month extension is permitted; a second requires Branch Manager approval.

Performance: Confirmed employees receive reviews in June and December using the four stated rating categories. Ratings feed into the July increment cycle and December bonus.

Conduct: Employees must not accept gifts or cash from customers or vendors. Gifts over PKR 1,000 must be declared to HR within three days. Relevant conflicts of interest must be declared in writing at joining and when they change.

Discipline: The normal sequence is verbal counsel, written warning, final written warning, suspension without pay, and termination. Specified gross misconduct skips the ladder and moves to termination after investigation.

Separation: Confirmed employees provide one calendar month's notice. Exit interview, full-and-final settlement, and asset return are mandatory before the last working day. The experience certificate is issued within seven working days of clearance.